

be arranged by last played, developer, or by its ESRB rating. The best feature though is that the Games Explorer leverages the system's rating to give you a quick view on whether or not the game will run on your system.

11.2.1 System Rating Or The Windows Experience Index

Based on the components of your system, Windows Vista assigns a numeric score to each of your core sub-systems. Thus your hardware is rated on the basis of: your system's processor, the amount of RAM present in the system, the graphics capability of the system, the gaming graphics capability of the system, and the performance of the primary hard disk drive. Vista first assigns numeric ratings to each of these components; it then takes the lowest component score and rates the entire system by that score. This then becomes the system's Windows Experience Index, or the system's rating. This rating is then used to not only suggest software suitable to your system but also get a quick look at whether a game will run as intended by the developer on your system.

For example, let's assume that your system rating is 4.2 and you have recently installed a game that requires a minimum of 3.0 and a recommended rating of 4.5 of your system. This game will run fine on your system but you might not be able to run it in full detail. Note that such information is only available from games that are Vista-aware and are labelled as "Games for Windows."



Rating